

Danger Zone -- Kenny Loggins

From the *Top Gun* soundtrack (1986). About 158 BPM, est.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

The low-end pulse on the record sounds sequenced-synth, typical of a Moroder production. On bass that becomes relentless, even picked eighths with a synthetic edge.

The CTL trick: Octa adds a sub-octave for a fat, synth-wall chorus.

Use a pick with a consistent down-pick. Both pickups up. Tone knob around 70%. Mute hard with the fretting hand so the eighths are staccato like a sequencer.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Hartke410 IR (User IR 6)

A bright SVT into Hartke410's aluminum cones. It's a hard, clicky attack that reads like a synth envelope.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 20.

THRE 20 chops the tails so the eighths stay staccato, like a sequencer.

PRE -- OCTA (polyphonic octave), on CTL.

Low: 45, High: 0, Dry: 80.

A sub-octave under the pulse, Low 45 and Dry 80. Single-note eighths track cleanly. Avoid chords with it on.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 30, Blend: 30, VOL: 55, Bass: 50, Treble: 55.

Grit on top of the sub for the synth-wall chorus.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 30, Bass: 55, Middle: 52, MidFreq: 800Hz, Treble: 60, VOL: 64.

Bright SVT with an 800Hz mid focus.

CAB -- User IR 6 (Hartke410), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: +2, 150Hz: 0, 600Hz: -3, 2kHz: +3, 8kHz: +1, VOL: 52.

Sub up, a 600Hz scoop, and a 2kHz lift give the synthetic curve.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Dry. Sequencers don't have room reverb.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: PRE (Octa), DST (Bass OD).

- **CTL off** -- Verses. Tight, bright, picked eighth-note pulse. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Choruses ("Highway to the Danger Zone"). Sub-octave plus grit for a fat, synth-like wall.

Engage at each chorus. Off for the verses.